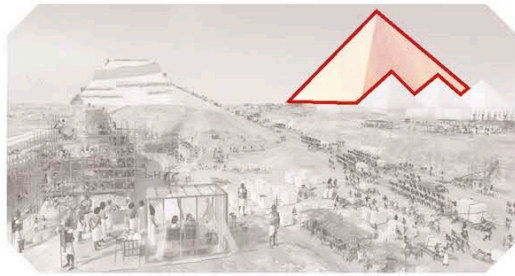


IN THE GREAT PYRAMID

Khafre's father, the Pharaoh Khufu, knew that the treasures buried with him would be tempting for grave robbers. So, he had his pyramid designed with several layers of defense, hoping that thieves would be unable to get in once his burial chamber was sealed. Unfortunately for Khufu, his defenses were not enough to dissuade the grave robbers—his chamber is thought to have been plundered within a few hundred years of his death.

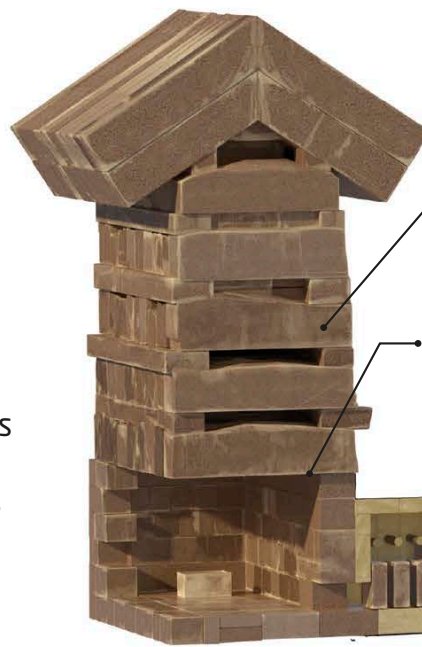


This statuette of Khufu is made of ivory. It was found at Abydos, Egypt.



Pharaoh Khufu

Khufu was the first pharaoh to build a pyramid at Giza. His is the biggest of them all. It is precisely aligned north-south and almost a perfect square.



The capstone at the very top of the pyramid may once have been covered in gold.

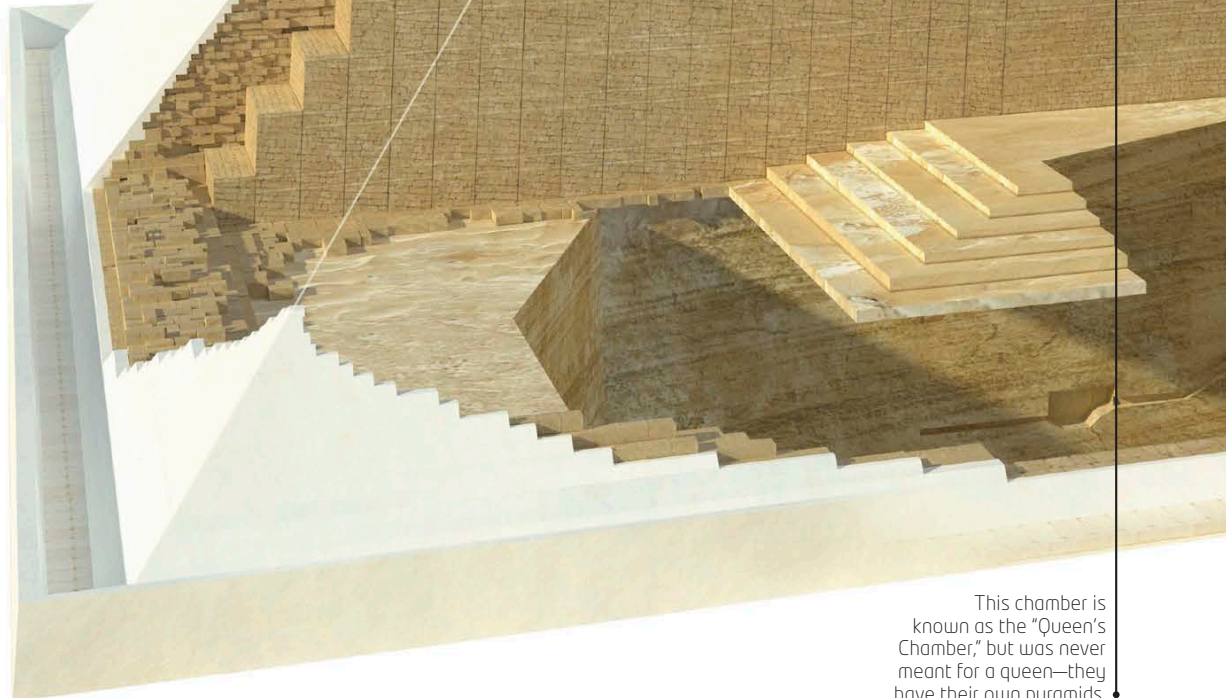
Five chambers are stacked on top of the King's Chamber, to relieve the pressure on it from the mass of stone above.

The nine granite slabs that form the ceiling of the King's Chamber are 18 ft (5.5 m) long and weigh around 25-40 tons each.

The King's Chamber

At the heart of the pyramid is Khufu's burial chamber. It is lined entirely with red granite, and holds a matching granite sarcophagus (stone coffin). Three huge blocks of granite were used to close off the entrance to the chamber.

Construction blocks quarried from the surrounding desert rocks form giant steps beneath the outer layer of white limestone.



This chamber is known as the "Queen's Chamber," but was never meant for a queen—they have their own pyramids.